Giving Talks and Teachings #1

MINDFULNESS MEDITATION TEACHER CERTIFICATION PROGRAM

Introduction to Mindfulness Overview of Teaching and Practices

TEACHINGS

Nature of Suffering First and Second Noble Truths

Wise Attention What is mindfulness and how does it serve awakening and freedom? Concentration? Lovingkindness or compassion? (This could be framed within two wings of understanding and compassion.)

Hindrances This includes how the second foundation of feeling gives rise to expressions of clinging and aversion

Wise Effort The effort to be present; cultivating skillful mind states and not fueling unskillful mind states

Wise Attitude Toward practice and path; acceptance, kindness, non-judgment; patience; perseverance

Wise Intention Aspiration

Ethics Non-violence, reverence for life, compassion in action

Wise Understanding Seeing impermanence; cause of suffering; emptiness of self and all phenomena

PRACTICES

Concentration Choosing an anchor (primarily breath; possibly sound, sensations, etc.) and developing some capacity to quiet and focus mind

Mindfulness Recognize what is happening without judgment in the moment-to-moment flow of experience

- Important to describe relationship between concentration and mindfulness
- Helpful to use two questions: What is happening right now? Can I be with this?
- Introduce foundations—primarily focus on body/breath, emotions, thoughts
- Supports: Relaxation; body scan (embodied awareness); noting; lenses (microscopic to wide angle)
- Introduce RAIN in dealing with difficult experience (recognize, allow, investigate, non-identification)
- Choiceless awareness—mindfulness of whatever is predominant (not directing or controlling anything, just noticing and allowing)

Lovingkindness, Forgiveness, and Compassion Meditations

Mindfulness in Daily Life Using the pause; conscious breathing; body as anchor; power of intention; possibly introduce eating meditation and/or walking meditation

Introduction to Mindfulness Class Topics

FOUR-WEEK CLASS

1. Why Meditate? Mindfulness of Breath and Body
2. Mindfulness of Emotions and Feelings
3. Mindfulness of Thoughts
4. Mindfulness in Daily Life

SIX-WEEK CLASS

1. Why Meditate? Mindful Presence
2. Breath, Body, and Walking
3. Lovingkindness and Compassion for Self and Other
4. Feelings and Emotions
5. Thoughts and the Mind
6. Wise Intention, Embodiment, and Daily Practice

EIGHT-WEEK CLASS

1. Why Meditate? Mindful Presence
   - The value of mindfulness and compassion in your life
   - The power of inner training and how neuroscience supports this
   - Beginning to practice
   - Presence of body and senses
   - Presence with others
2. Breath
   - The art of steadying attention
   - Why mindfulness of breathing? Its universal nature.
   - Common initial difficulties
   - Using other anchors
3. Body and Walking
4. Lovingkindness and Compassion for Self and Other
5. Feelings and Emotions
6. Thoughts and the Mind
7. Wise Intention
8. Embodiment and Daily Practice

Giving Talks and Teachings #3

MINDFULNESS MEDITATION TEACHER CERTIFICATION PROGRAM

Dharma Talk Themes

Anxiety and trust
Attachment and healthy connection
Beginner's mind/seeing anew
Compassion
Conflict and care
Daily practice
Desire and addiction
Dignity, courage, and presence
Equanimity and peace
Ethics and integrity
Expectation and the planning mind
Family practice
Forgiveness
Generosity
Healing body and mind
Hindrances and common difficulties
Impermanence and wisdom
Intervening
Joy
Lovingkindness
Mindfulness
Mindfulness of feelings and emotions
Mindfulness of the body, pleasure, and pain
Mindfulness of thoughts and mind states
Presence
RAIN
Sangha and community
Self-compassion
Service and the bodhisattva
Suffering, its cause, and its end
Wise community
Wise intention
Wise speech
Working with resistance to practice

ADDITIONAL BUDDHIST CLASSICS

Four Noble Truths
Eight-Fold Path
Five Hindrances
Seven Factors of Enlightenment
Four Foundations of Mindfulness
Four Brahma Viharas/the Awakened Heart
Five Spiritual Powers of Faith, Wisdom, Energy, Concentration, and Mindfulness
Six or Ten Perfections